

The Harbour Almanac

Tides, moorings and weather for small boats.

Contents

Welcome aboard

Quick reference

Part 1: Harbour

Part 2: Open water

Appendix

Welcome aboard

A small book for people who stay near the shore.

How to use this book

Each part of the almanac covers one kind of trip. Read the part that matches your plan, then keep the quick reference in your pocket. Extra notes live in the Harbour Almanac online notes.

Reading the tide table

The tide table lists the high and low water for the day. Three habits help:

Note the time of the next high water.

Add an hour in summer.

Write the result on the chart.

Quick reference

One page of habits for the start of every trip.

BEFORE YOU SAIL

1. Check the forecast.
2. Check the tide.
3. Tell someone your plan.

MOORING LOG

```
{  
  "boat": "Margot",  
  "berth": "B12",  
  "tide_ft": 3.4  
}
```

TIP

Keep one spare line coiled near the bow.

1

Harbour

Where the boat sleeps.

Choosing a mooring

A good mooring is sheltered from the wind that blows most often. Look at the bottom, the swing room and the distance to the landing steps before you decide.

2

Open water

Further out, with a plan.

Weather windows

A window is a stretch of hours when wind and swell stay below your limit.

Reading the sky

High thin cloud often comes before a change. Low dark cloud means rain soon.

Night passages

Keep the route simple at night. Choose marks that have a light you can name.

Appendix

Glossary

Berth: the place where a boat is tied up.

Swing room: the circle a moored boat can turn in.